

Name: _____

Date: _____

Where Does Rain Come From?

Year 4 reading comprehension · Information text · 13 marks · About 20 minutes

Round and round

The water on Earth is always moving. It travels from the sea to the sky, down to the ground and back again. This journey is called the water cycle, and it has been going on for billions of years.

Up into the sky

When the sun warms the sea, lakes and rivers, some of the water turns into an invisible gas called water vapour. This is called evaporation. The warm water vapour rises into the air.

Making clouds

High in the sky, the air is much colder. The water vapour cools down and turns back into tiny drops of liquid water. This is called condensation. Millions of these tiny drops gather together to make a cloud. A cloud may look solid, but it is really a huge crowd of floating drops.

Falling down

When the drops in a cloud become too heavy, they fall as rain, snow or hail. This is called precipitation. The water runs into streams and rivers, or soaks into the soil, and flows back to the sea. Then the whole cycle begins again. After heavy rain, rivers can fill quickly, which is why some places flood.

1. What is the journey that water makes from the sea to the sky and back again called? (1 mark)

2. What does the sun's warmth turn some of the water into? (1 mark)

3. The text calls water vapour "invisible". What does "invisible" mean? (1 mark)

4. Match each word to its meaning by writing the correct letter. (3 marks)

1. evaporation 2. condensation 3. precipitation

A. water falling as rain, snow or hail

B. water vapour cooling into tiny drops

C. liquid water turning into water vapour

1 = _____ 2 = _____ 3 = _____

5. Why is it important that the air high in the sky is much colder? (2 marks)

6. The text says the water cycle “has been going on for billions of years”. What does this suggest about the water we drink today? (2 marks)

7. Name two things that can fall from a cloud when the drops get too heavy. (1 mark)

8. Write one or two sentences to explain how a cloud is made. (2 marks)

Writing task: Pretend you are a drop of water travelling around the water cycle. Write about your journey.
